



NURSE

JOB DESCRIPTION

Nurses provide care and assistance for people who are ill, injured, or suffering from health problems. They administer treatments and therapies, plan patient care, and provide advice and practical support. There are opportunities to specialize and work at different locations, including hospitals, health centers, schools, and hospices, as well as in private practices.



SALARY

Licensed practical nurse ★★★★★
Nurse practitioner ★★★★★

INDUSTRY PROFILE

Great demand for nurses across the world • Numbers expected to rise along with the aging population and advances in medical science • Pay levels very structured

▼ RELATED CAREERS

- ▶ **MEDICAL DOCTOR** *see pp. 276–277*
- ▶ **MIDWIFE** *see pp. 280–281*
- ▶ **HOME HEALTH NURSE** Visits the homes of patients who require care such as intermittent health monitoring, medication administration, and post-surgical wound care.
- ▶ **SCHOOL NURSE** Works in schools to conduct health checks, teach about diet and exercise, and administer medication and care for children during the school day.

**There are more
nurses than any
other role in the
health care profession.**

AT A GLANCE



YOUR INTERESTS Biology • Health and social service • Caring for people • Science • Psychology • Sociology • Medicine and pharmaceuticals



ENTRY QUALIFICATIONS You need a degree in nursing. You must also pass a national licensing exam and receive continuing-education credits yearly.



LIFESTYLE Nurses usually work a regular number of hours overall. However, this includes shifts in the evenings, overnight, and on weekends.



LOCATION Nurses work out of hospitals, day care centers, schools, or hospices. They may also see patients for home visits or talk to children in schools.



THE REALITIES Nursing can be physically and emotionally demanding. Financial rewards improve with further qualifications and increased responsibility.